

LD BRAIN — KNOWLEDGE CAPTURE

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LD Silk Mills — Procurement

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ESTIMATED TIME	60–90 minutes (2–3 sessions if needed)

GAPS CLOSED BY THIS QUESTIONNAIRE

S4, S15, S16

Why this questionnaire? The LD Brain is the group's knowledge system. Most of what you know about mills, fabrics, and procurement lives in your head — and that is the group's most valuable undocumented asset. This session is about capturing your expertise so the business is never dependent on memory alone. This is not an audit. These are questions only you can answer.

Gaps this closes: S4 (mill network), S15 (fabric compositions), S16 (series-level customer map)

SECTION A — THE MILL NETWORK

We want to document your mill relationships so the business doesn't depend on memory alone.

A1. Your top 10 mills — who are they? For the mills you work with most often, we want to know:

- Mill name and location (Surat? Bhilwara? Mumbai?)
- How many years have you been buying from them?
- What is the name of your contact person at each mill?
- Do you have their personal mobile number or only the office number?
- If you stopped buying from them, could someone else at LD Silk rebuild that relationship from scratch?

A2. Distress sale access One of Silk's biggest advantages is getting first call on distress/clearance stock.

- Which mills call you first when they have excess/distress inventory? (Name them)
- How do these calls come — WhatsApp, direct call, or through a broker?
- Is this relationship personal (they trust you) or transactional (they call everyone)?
- If you were not available for 2 weeks, would they still call LD Silk — or would the call go to a competitor?

A3. Mill succession risk

- Are any of your key mills going through ownership changes, financial stress, or quality issues?
- Are there any mills where your contact person is old and retiring soon? (Who replaces them?)
- Are there mills where you've noticed quality declining over the last 1–2 years? Which ones?

A4. New mill discovery

- In the last 12 months, have you started buying from any new mills that are performing well?
 - Are there mills you've rejected in the past that might now be worth a second look?
 - What process do you use to evaluate a new mill for the first time?
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SECTION B — FABRIC KNOWLEDGE (COMPOSITION DATA)

Our SAB system shows 540 out of 620 fabric quality names have "Na" for composition. This gap affects pricing, cross-selling to Linkd, and selling to export buyers who require composition labels.

B1. Top 30 fabric compositions Starting with the highest-volume fabrics in our live selling range (159 healthy SKUs), we need to document:

- What is the fabric made of? (e.g., "60% Polyester, 35% Viscose, 5% Lycra")
- What width does it come in?
- What is the GSM approximately?
- What is the weave type? (plain, twill, dobby, satin...)

We will prepare a list of the top 30 fabric names to go through with you. For each one, 30 seconds of your time is enough.

B2. Print suitability for Linkd For each of the ~50–60 fabrics that contain significant polyester:

- Is this fabric suitable for digital sublimation printing at Linkd?
- Have you ever tried printing any of these at Linkd or elsewhere? What was the result?
- Which fabrics would you recommend as new Linkd printing substrates that we haven't tried yet?

B3. Series-level customer map This is pure knowledge extraction — no system can give us this.

- Which customers specifically buy London? Who are the regular London buyers?
- Who specifically buys Innova? Are they different customers from London buyers?
- Who buys Dominoz? Is it a different price-point customer?
- Are there customers who buy ONLY one specific fabric family and nothing else? Who?
- Are there fabrics where if the price moves by ₹5, the customer immediately goes to a competitor?

SECTION C — DEAD STOCK POST-MORTEMS

We have 65 dead/dormant SKUs with stock. For each dead SKU, there's a buying decision that didn't work out. The learning is more valuable than the fabric itself.

C1. Titan (5,861 mtrs) — Why is it dead?

- When was Titan last bought? For which customer?
- Why did it stop selling? (Customer stopped, trend died, quality issue, competition?)
- Was there a specific event that killed Titan's demand, or did it fade gradually?
- Can it be sold now — to whom, at what price, and what percentage recovery?

C2. Chip Plain (5,496 mtrs, never sold)

- This was purchased and has never had a single sale. What was the original intent?

- Was it bought on a tip from a customer who then didn't follow through? Or was it a speculative buy?
- Who approved this purchase?
- What should happen to it: liquidate, repurpose at Cotton, or donate?

C3. Merit Plain (2,903 mtrs, bought Feb 2026, zero sales)

- This is the most urgent: bought just 2 months ago and not a single meter sold.
- Who was the intended customer when this was purchased?
- Did that customer confirm interest before the purchase, or was it speculative?
- What is the correct action now?

C4. General dead stock rule Based on your experience:

- What is the most common reason fabrics end up as dead stock? (Wrong trend call? Customer-specific buy that fell through? Price too high to move?)
- Is there a pattern — any mill, any fabric category, any season that produces more dead stock?
- What is the maximum you would buy of a new, unproven fabric quality on a first trial?

SECTION D — PRICING INSTINCTS

Your price instincts are the most valuable undocumented asset in LD Silk. We want to capture them.

D1. Rate benchmarks by category For a new salesperson who doesn't know pricing:

- What is the "never go below" rate for a standard Tier 1 finished fabric (London, Innova, Polo-type)?
- What is the floor rate for a standard Tier 4 digital/print fabric (Milano, Canvas-type)?
- When a mill quotes a price, how do you know if it's a good price vs a bad price?

D2. The "too cheap" warning

- Have you ever seen a mill offer a fabric at a price that was suspiciously low? What happened?
- What does it mean when a fabric is priced 20% below your expectation? (Quality issue? Fake? Distress sale?)

D3. Margin by category (rough) Not asking for exact numbers — just your sense:

- Which fabric category (Tier 1 finished, grey-processed, linen, digital) gives Silk the best margins?
- Which category has the thinnest margins?
- Which category are you happiest selling more of, and which would you rather reduce?

After answering, please share responses with Mahesh. Answers will be entered into the LD Brain and gaps will be marked closed.